I pray to you to teach me not just the ability to answer, but also the power to question.

Everyone is telling me to do as I am told. Before I know it, I am **enslaved.** It is because we do not ask questions. Only if we ask questions, can we get answers. If we get the answers, we can explore how to establish a better order of things. If we ask questions, we will also learn to be accountable. We will be more willing to accept that when we ask the questions, we can be questioned too. In that exchange, truth will emerge.

As I learn the power of humility, teach me about how all things that sustain life on earth, come free.

Teacher, I will live in an increasingly **commercial** world. I will be judged on how much "value" I can create by buying and selling things. My personal success will be determined by my ability to consume. I will not be able to always question the ways of the world, but do tell me how all things that truly support life, come without payment.



The cow does not get paid for the milk she gives us.



The earth does not ask for money for the crops we get.



The sea does not come to get royalties on the catch of the day.



The sun, the air, the river and the clouds do not get paid for their services.

I pray to you to teach me the power of silence – teach me also to raise my voice to protect the truth.

In a world where every moment is going to be full of noise, teach me to be quiet. Teach me to appreciate the sound of silence. For, in silence I can **contemplate** the power within.

Teach me to make my point without having to raise my voice.

And teach me to raise my voice, teacher, when my silence can hurt another life.

GLOSSARY		
enslaved	-	made someone slave
commercial	-	money minded
contemplate	-	think deeply about something

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